



## DB CoTD: Is EM a huge tech play?

\*\*\* The Extel (formerly II) Global Fixed-Income analyst survey launched this week. Here at DB we would all like to do as well as we can so will be campaigning hard over the next three weeks. If you've voted before you should now have a ballot. Details of how to try to register for a ballot if you haven't had one before, or instructions on how to vote for me and in what categories can be found [here](#). The main categories I would love a 5-star vote are 1) Global Macro Strategy, 2) Global Economics, 3) Developed Europe: Cross Asset Strategy, 4) Developed Europe: Fixed-Income Strategy and 5) Developed Europe: Economics. Many thanks. \*\*\*

This year's "Charts to make you go WOW!" pack also returned this week. It's designed to surprise, challenge, and reframe the big macro and market stories of the moment. It's become my favourite pack of the year to produce, and I hope you'll enjoy and go "WOW!" at least once, and preferably a number of times. You can see it [here](#) at the Deutsche Bank Research Institute. On Tuesday 14<sup>th</sup> July, I'll also be hosting a webinar to run through the pack at 14:00 London time. The link to register is [here](#).

For most of the past two decades, owning equities outside the US has often made investors question whether diversification or valuations really matter. The ex-US ETF in today's CoTD, taken from the "WOW!" pack, was slightly lower in price terms at the start of 2025 than it was in June 2007, with the EM ETF similar. Over the same period, the S&P 500 nearly quadrupled. While the S&P 500 has performed strongly, the more recent story has been the outperformance of the rest of the world. What changed?

Ex-US indices have typically been more heavily weighted towards the "old economy" sectors, like financials, energy, materials and industrials, with less exposure to the mega-cap tech stocks that powered the S&P 500 through the 2010s.

However, trends and momentum have shifted since then. Previously unloved sectors in the traditional economy are now being supported by the shifting geopolitical backdrop. The renewed focus on defence and industrial self-sufficiency is just one example. In addition, AI-driven capex is spilling over into power, hardware and materials. These are precisely the sectors where RoW and EM indices tend to be overweight. This is all being accelerated by growing fiscal activism. Germany's stimulus is the big DM example. But the trend is growing in countries that comprise the EM indices. In Mexico, a massive investment in traditional-economy rail infrastructure is taking place even as the country focuses

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on reducing its budget deficit. As an indicator of the resurgence in the traditional economy, European banks (laggards for nearly 15 years) have massively re-rated on improved profitability. That comes as expectations that the US dollar's 2010–2024 bull run (around +40%) may plateau after it acted as a persistent drag on unhedged overseas returns for dollar-based investors. In 2025, it fell by over 9%, its worst year since 2017, even if there has been some reversal this year.

That said, it is worth noting that the outperformance of both indices has increasingly been driven by tech. The three largest names in both indices in today's CoTD are now TSMC, Samsung and SK hynix. Nearly 30% of the EM index is concentrated in these three companies, and in the world index (ex US) it's nearly 10%.

The top 10 holdings in the world index remain relatively low at 16.8%. By contrast, the EM index has seen a sharp rise in concentration, with its top 10 now accounting for 39.4% — above the S&P 500 at 36.7%.

So, somewhat ironically, buying an EM ETF today is effectively a large tech play. That may be positive or negative, but it means that a typical EM ETF looks very different from what many generalist investors might assume.

Figure 1: iShares MSCI ACWI ex U.S. ETF



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank

Figure 2: iShares MSCI Emerging Markets ETF



Source : Bloomberg Finance LP, Deutsche Bank



# Appendix 1

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